

You cant criticize an individual for using AI for the environmental effects while having destructive hobbies yourself

Posted by u/Secure-Evening • 0 points • 90 comments

This is not about bringing up environmental effects, pressuring companies to be more sustainable or anything productive. It's for people that actively judge individuals for using AI because of the negative effects on the environment. Sometimes you'll see someone post a silly little AI image and then someone will be like "Hope poisoning a town in Texas was worth it" or "This meme wasted 8 gallons of water. Congrats. "

Unless you're is very particular about your environmental foot print and wouldn't have a hobby that did major damage than how can you really judge someone else for also having a damaging hobby?

If you're a reader who primarily reads new books for instance your water consumption is massive. Many plants poison the environment and local communities while also clear cutting forests so you could read a book physically. Or artists who use canvas and pigments that also poison the environment. Or if you're a make up artist using mica mined by poor children in terrible conditions. The list goes on. Not to mention basic things like gaming, Netflix or YouTube.

It's hypocritical to judge someone else for doing the same thing you're doing.

Comments

u/Fair-Snow-6201 • 1 points • 2025-12-22 13:55 UTC

Yes, you absolutely can.

u/Josparov • 1 points • 2025-12-21 22:39 UTC

If your stated argument is consistent, then you also cannot criticize oil producers for dumping crude oil into the Gulf of Mexico, or mining operations strip mining.

Oh, I see you are wearing any kind of name brand fashion apparel, I better not hear you talking about child slavery laws.

Literally an appeal to hypocrisy fallacy. People doing bad things does not make the bad thing you do good or acceptable or just. It is a poor excuse for bad behavior.

But yes. It does make them insufferable hypocrites.

u/Secure-Evening • 1 points • 2025-12-22 17:31 UTC

That's not the same thing. We're talking individual harm where we are indirectly causing harm by supporting environmentally damaging companies for our hobbies.

If I stop using AI or buying acrylic paint, there's still environmental harm being caused by these companies cause I'm not directly responsible for their actions. If I was dumping oil into Mexico, there'd be no additional oil in the Gulf of Mexico. The harm is stopped.

Also I'm not talking about criticizing the laws or the companies. Even if you're buying from those companies you have every right to criticize them. But you have no right to say that the person wearing Gucci is practically a child slaver where you're wearing Prada that's made in the exact same way.

u/Odd-Possible6036 • 1 points • 2025-12-21 15:37 UTC

Yes you can. Every human is a hypocrite.

u/Southern_Conflict_11 • 1 points • 2025-12-21 13:02 UTC

Not a single individual person's water consumption or conservation is meaningful.

u/StealthyRobot • 1 points • 2025-12-20 07:11 UTC

I like AI as a technology. I think what it has done, and what it can do, are very cool, and can be very beneficial as well.

The way data centers are being built is bad. Using municipal water is bad, and raises prices for consumers. Even worse by magnitudes is the power consumption, and the reckless methods being used to power many of them. New centers are constantly being built, they're always training new models.

Blaming consumers isn't going to help. It's the companies that need to be held accountable, and above that, the counties and people on charge allowing a water and power hungry center to be built in a low income town and use 30 methane producing generators to power it.

I wish I could be stoked about ai, but the environmental impact is real and can't be ignored.

u/HighBiased • 2 points • 2025-12-20 05:05 UTC

Its water use is not great, but it's nothing compared to how much water corn devours. And only a tiny fraction of corn is used for food.